



Photograph Gaurav Pranshu Garg

Each month *Digit* will carry a caption for a photo. Come up with something funnier, and beat the *Digit* team at their own game! Entries accepted by the 20th of this month.

Beat That!

Digit Caption

"Port-a-print"

Last Month's Winner!

Milind Sarwate,
Chief-HR & Strategy, Marico Ltd

"This is the mouse that Hack built!"



E-mail your caption with the subject "Beat That", and your postal address, to beatthat@thinkdigit.com and win

Windows & Linux Integration

by Jeremy Moskowitz and Thomas Boutell

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live happily ever after. In the US, however, stricter laws lead to people having no choice. In fact, some PC vendors actually charge extra to give you a cleaned out Windows. Yes, you actually pay more for less with that solution! For now, you should get the PC Decrapifier from www.pcdecrapifier.com, and clean up your PC.

Good news from PC vendors is that Dell has decided to bring back Windows XP, so you can get cheaper versions of high end hardware. Of course, since Dell is doing it, all the others will follow suit.

THE GOOGLE SPIES

Search Giant Will Now Know More About You

Recently, Google announced plans to buy DoubleClick, the digital marketing giant, for 3.1 billion dollars (about

Rs 13,950 crore) *in cash!* For Google, which already has a booming business that garners advertising revenue, this will make them a formidable force for online advertising. End users, however, seem to be more worried about how much information Google will now have on each of us. They already know what we're looking for, those with Gmail have already agreed to let Google computers read their mail, and now they will know what sites we visit, and decide what ads we see. Thus far Google has been behind the text ads you see when you search, while DoubleClick is behind a lot of the banner / fixed ads you see on sites. With this merger, soon we might see Google controlling every single ad you see online!

Microsoft was quick to condemn the move: Brad Smith, general counsel for Microsoft said, "This proposed acquisition raises serious competition and privacy concerns. We think this merger deserves close scrutiny from regulatory

authorities to ensure a competitive online advertising market." Of course, rumours doing the rounds suggest that Microsoft was beaten by Google in the bid war to buy DoubleClick, so it could just be a case of sour grapes. Pity.

The news has already started making top headlines everywhere at the time of writing this. There's even rumours that three public interest groups—Electronic Privacy Information Center (EPIC), Center for Digital Democracy (CDD) and U.S. Public Interest Research Group—will jointly file a complaint against the merger with the US Federal Trade Commission. According to what we hear, the groups will file the case on behalf of the 1.1 billion Internet users across the globe, opposing any merger until it's clearer how Google uses the data it stores, and makes a public formal announcement indicating how it will use all the data it gathers.

Nicole Wong, deputy general counsel for Google

said, "User, advertiser and publisher trust is paramount to the success of our business and to the success of the acquisition. We can't imagine taking any actions that would undermine these relationships or the trust people have in using our products and services."

With all the hullabaloo about this merger, we decided to make a list of everything Google would know about any one of us (if you use all of their services), and this is what we got:

- 1. Search:** There's no doubt that the majority of us use Google Search. If you're signed into your account, Google already knows who you are and has your email address. It will now know exactly what you look for online. If you're not signed in, it still ties your IP to your preferences.
- 2. Gmail:** What's the best way to get users to identify themselves? Offer them a really cool new e-mail service; make it invite only to raise the "I want!" factor, and then collect loads of